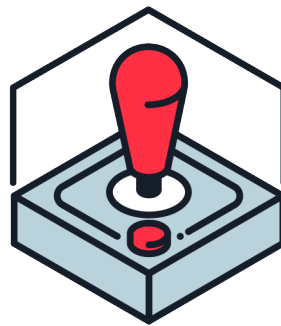




Video Game Metadata Schema: Controlled Vocabulary for **MECHANICS**

University of Washington Information School
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GAMER
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Version History

1.0: November 2014, Initial release

1.1: September 2024

1.1: December 2024, Formatting update: Updated reference structure for improved visual clarity and ease of use, with no changes to content. Table formatting was removed, and relationships between terms are now displayed hierarchically through indentation, with narrower terms shown as subsets of broader terms. Included relevant term relationships (SN, USE, USE FOR, RT) as appropriate.

Abbreviation Key

The following abbreviations are used throughout:

SN: Scope note

USE: Preferred term (See)

USE FOR: Equivalent term, lead-in term

RT: Related term (See also)

Controlled Vocabulary for Mechanics

Activation

SN: User has no agency outside of activating either the game or their turn.

USE FOR: **None, Random Chance**

Examples: Slot machines, *Candy Land*

Avoiding

SN: Taking action to preclude encountering unwanted objects or circumstances.

RT: **Jumping**

Examples: *Asteroids*, *Super Mario Bros.*, *Pac-Man*

Building

SN: Creating objects in the environment.

Examples: *Minecraft*, *The Sims*, *SimCity*

Card Playing

SN: Selecting for use an object from a set of similar objects (cards, tiles, etc.).

Examples: *Hearthstone*, *Magic: The Gathering Arena*

Choosing

SN: Selecting an option from a set of choices.

Examples: *Mass Effect*, *You Don't Know Jack*

Climbing

SN: Navigating along a vertically-inclined, non-ground surface.

Examples: *Shadow of the Colossus*, *Assassin's Creed*

Collecting

SN: Acquiring a set of objects.

Examples: *Pac-Man*, *Katamari Damacy*, *Goat Simulator*

Crafting

SN: Combining objects to create a new object.

Examples: *Minecraft*, *Doodle God*, *Skyrim*

Deck Building

SN: Selecting a subset of objects for later use.

Examples: *Hearthstone*, *Magic: The Gathering Arena*

Destroying

SN: Destroying objects in the environment.

Examples: *Minecraft*, *Red Faction*, *Monster Truck Destruction*

Drawing

SN: Using freeform input to create a design as either a creation tool or command input.

Examples: *Line Rider*, *Ōkami*

Driving

SN: navigating a vehicle through the environment. 'Vehicle' is defined as any object conforming to movement rules (e.g. car, skateboard, horse, etc.).

USE FOR: **Flying, Piloting, Sailing, Riding**

Examples: *Grand Theft Auto, Forza, Mech Warrior, Star Fox*

Fighting

SN: Characters attempting to exert their power over others through force.

Examples: *Super Smash Bros., League of Legends, Hyrule Warriors*

Flying

USE: **Driving**

Grab & Release

SN: Picking up and setting down objects.

Examples: *Octodad: Dadliest Catch*

Hitting

SN: Exerting force on an object already in motion.

RT: **Shooting**

Examples: *Pinball, Baseball, Piano Tiles*

Input Combinations

SN: A specific sequence of inputs which result in a single event.

Examples: *Tony Hawk's Pro Skater, Marvel vs. Capcom*

Jumping

SN: Causing a character to jump in the environment.

RT: **Avoiding**

Examples: *Super Mario Bros., Sonic the Hedgehog*

Matching

SN: Connecting similar objects through positioning or identification.

Examples: *Bejeweled, Puzzle & Dragon, Memory*

None

USE: **Activation**

Pattern Matching

SN: Player repeats or simultaneously responds to game patterns.

Examples: *Guitar Hero, Dance Dance Revolution, Simon Says*

Piloting

USE: **Driving**

Positioning

SN: Placing or moving objects or events within the game world as a necessary gameplay element to advance to the next level/zone (Block placement in puzzle games, unit placement in tactics games with stat impact, etc.).

Examples: *Sudoku, Plants vs. Zombies, Tetris, Dear Esther*

Programming

SN: Utilizing programming logic to create game behaviors.

Examples: *Omega*, *Codecombat*, *Gidget*

Random Chance

USE: **Activation**

Resource Management

SN: Selecting how and when to gather or use resources.

Examples: *League of Legends*, *Plants vs. Zombies*, *The Sims*

Sailing

USE: **Driving**

Sharing

SN: Transferral of a game object from one player to another.

Examples: *Minecraft*, *Farmville*

Shooting

SN: Applying directional force to a stationary object.

Examples: *Call of Duty*, *Bubble Bobble*, *Pool*

Sneaking

SN: Movement with the intent of evading detection of other game entities.

Examples: *Metal Gear Solid*, *Assassin's Creed*, *Stealth Bastard*

Swiping

SN: Using a sustained pointer motion to create an event.

Examples: *Fruit Ninja*, *Cooking Mama*

Text Input

SN: Entering text to produce commands or provide data.

Examples: *Zork*, *The Typing of The Dead: Overkill*